

- 50.** The way to perform the vigil was
- (a) to chant mystic numbers
 - (b) to go to the plains or the plateaus
 - (c) to fast and wait alone
 - (d) to make it last as long as possible

PASSAGE 16

An 11 year boy walking behind his parents and a pet dog off England's highest cliffs, which rise to 230 m at their peak, blown off in a gale to a height of at least 170 m. The gale drowned out the boy's screams while his parents walked on ahead. They realised what had happened only when the dog barked furiously at a helicopter flying in the sky. The pilot of the helicopter displayed exemplary presence of mind and picked up the boy from the cliff to the great relief of his parents who found him alive and kicking.

- 51.** The parents did not hear the boy scream because
- (a) they were far away
 - (b) of the sound of the gale
 - (c) of the drone of the helicopter
 - (d) of the barking of the dog
- 52.** The gale struck the boy while he was
- (a) jumping off the cliff
 - (b) playing with the dog
 - (c) looking at the helicopter
 - (d) walking behind his parents
- 53.** The parents discovered the mishap only when they
- (a) saw the helicopter rescuing the boy
 - (b) heard the dog barking furiously
 - (c) realised the fury of the gale
 - (d) noticed the destruction of plants and trees

PASSAGE 17

The dabbawallahs are partly a by-product of Mumbai's overcrowding. There was a time when many men could get home to take their lunch, but those more comfortable days ended as the city grew. But the conservatism of married men being well known, they still wanted home-made lunch. An Indian loves his lunch as much as anybody and feels that only his wife can guarantee the quality, quantity he requires, that restaurant food is expensive, of poorer quality and is served in meagre portions.

- 54.** According to the author, the dabbawallahs
- (a) are responsible for the overcrowding of Mumbai
 - (b) often create a lot of problems for the city
 - (c) have come mostly from rural areas
 - (d) came into existence as a consequence of Mumbai's overcrowding

- 55.** The past was more comfortable for the people of Mumbai because
- (a) many of them were rich and could afford good food
 - (b) they could bring home-made food for lunch
 - (c) many of them could go home to lunch
 - (d) they could eat their lunch outside
- 56.** Which of the following best describes the author's attitude to the dabbawallahs?
- (a) objective
 - (b) enthusiastic
 - (c) appreciative
 - (d) critical

PASSAGE 18

Birds which spend the summer in the higher reaches of mountains come down during the winter to the lower foothills or even the plains. This is very common in India where the mighty Himalayas lie close to the Indo-Gangetic plain. Birds are punctual too unless they are delayed by bad weather. We may calculate almost to a day when we may expect our bird friends to return, carrying winter on their backs. Some birds make the long journey in easy stages, stopping to rest on the way. Others fly great distances without pausing to rest and feed. Some fly by day, some both by day and by night, but most of them speed on their way through darkness after the Sun has set.

- 57.** During the winter, common birds in India
- (a) move higher towards the mountain
 - (b) come down to the foothills
 - (c) travel in the night
 - (d) remain where they had been staying
- 58.** Birds sometime get delayed in their migration because
- (a) they have to take rest and feed
 - (b) they lack the sense of time
 - (c) of bad weather
 - (d) they lose the sense of direction
- 59.** Mostly the birds make their long journey
- (a) during the day time
 - (b) at sunrise
 - (c) at midnight
 - (d) in the darkness

PASSAGE 19

The real reason why I should not like to be in the book trade for life is that while I was in it I lost my love of books. A bookseller has to tell lies about books and that gives him a distaste for them; still worse is the fact that he lies constantly dusting them and hauling them to and fro. There was a time when I really loved books—loved the sight and smell and feel of them, I mean, at least if they were fifty or more years old. Nothing pleased me quite so much as to buy a whole lot of them for a few rupees at an auction.

- 60.** The author lost his love of books
- (a) by not reading books for a long time
 - (b) by being in the book trade for a long time
 - (c) as he could not get good books to read
 - (d) as he was prevented from owning and reading books

- 61.** What is the most likely reason for a bookseller developing a distaste for books?
- (a) To sell books, he has to tell lies
 - (b) He has to constantly handle all kinds of bad books
 - (c) He has to be with books without reading them
 - (d) He has to satisfy the whims of the customers
- 62.** From the above passage it is clear that the author
- (a) liked to read books while working in the bookshop
 - (b) liked the outward appearance of books, their sight and smell, more than their contents
 - (c) liked to buy a lot of books at auctions
 - (d) never liked books as he had lost love for them

PASSAGE 20

I am convinced that school learning is unnatural and bad for human beings. In school, we sat on the floor and chorused our lessons. The teachers were terrible. They would write something on the board, ask us to take it down and go out to gossip or to smoke beedies. I was very naughty. I got punished and thrashed very often. But it did not stop me from mischief. My family insisted that I should attend school, but did not scold me when I failed. I barely managed to pass each year. It was the same story when I joined college. I scraped through my BA examination. What a relief it was to know that I need never go into a classroom again!

- 63.** From the passage which one of the following statements appears to be true?
- (a) The teacher used to punish the author everyday
 - (b) The punishment given by the teachers helped to improve the behaviour of the author
 - (c) The punishment did not stop the boy's mischief
 - (d) The punishment was so mild that the author enjoyed it
- 64.** 'I scraped through my BA examination' means that the author passed the BA examination
- (a) with great difficulty
 - (b) easily and with credits
 - (c) using unfair means
 - (d) only after several attempts
- 65.** Which one of the following statements truly indicates the author's opinion about the education system?
- (a) The author is appreciative of it
 - (b) He is highly critical and sarcastic about it
 - (c) He thinks that it is good but the teachers are bad
 - (d) He thinks that it is imperfect but can be improved

PASSAGE 21

As probably the least strenuous, safest physical activity, walking is the most acceptable exercise for the greatest number of people. Walking at comfortable speed improves the efficiency of the cardio-respiratory system by stimulating the lungs and the heart, but at a more gradual rate than most other forms of exercise. There is evidence that walking may actually open up narrowed areas in the coronary blood vessels, lessening chances of a heart attack.

For the tense person who smokes a 'killer' combination-walking offers added help by decreasing the abnormally high levels of carbon monoxide and nicotine in the blood. Walking may also increase the elasticity of the blood vessels, decreasing the likelihood that they will rupture under pressure due to a stroke.

- 66.** Walking is recommended because it
- (a) helps to reduce fat
 - (b) is inexpensive
 - (c) is not very strenuous
 - (d) is the only way to digest food
- 67.** The chances of a heart attack are
- (a) decreased by walking
 - (b) completely wiped out by walking
 - (c) temporarily postponed by walking
 - (d) unrelated to walking
- 68.** Strokes occur because of
- (a) the elasticity of blood vessels
 - (b) changes in blood pressure
 - (c) widening of arteries
 - (d) bursting of blood vessels

PASSAGE 22

There are many ways of sending secret messages. An interesting method was used by a Chinese General called Pingyo, approx. 2000 years ago. Pingyo's army was far from their homeland. Between the soldiers and home there were many enemies. But Pingyo sent letters to his king and the enemy could not read them. He sent them like this : A strong messenger was chosen from among the soldiers. His hair was cut off and a letter was written on his bald head. Then he was dressed as a poor farmer and sent home. His journey lasted many weeks. During this time, his hair grew and covered the message. The enemy stopped him many times. He was searched, but the letter was not found. When he reached the king's palace his hair was cut off again and the letter was read to the king.

- 69.** The messenger was dressed as a poor farmer as
- (a) he could walk fast
 - (b) farmers are less talkative
 - (c) the General favoured farmers
 - (d) a farmer would arouse less suspicion
- 70.** The messenger's hair was cut off because
- (a) a message could be written only on a bald head
 - (b) it would make the long journey comfortable
 - (c) the new hair would cover the message
 - (d) the bald head would make him look like a monk

- 71.** This method of sending the message was convenient as
- (a) the enemy could be cheated easily
 - (b) it was more economical
 - (c) the message was sent in person
 - (d) the message was not known to the messenger

PASSAGE 23

While the lion and the tiger are the focus of special conservation efforts due to their vastly reduced numbers, it is the leopard, among the big cats, that may now face the greater threat from poachers and illegal wildlife traders. The danger was brought home last year when sales inspectors stopped and searched a truck in Uttar Pradesh. They stumbled upon packages of leopard skins numbered and signed *Tsering*, the trade name of a major dealer, who, officers suspected, was planning to smuggle them out of India *via* Nepal and Tibet. There were also claws and other body parts. The leopard is threatened by exactly the same predators as the tiger by traditional medicine practitioners in China, Japan and other East Asian countries. Leopard parts can easily be mistaken for a tiger's and are greatly valued by apothecaries.

- 72.** There is fresh reason to pay attention to the reduced number of
- (a) cats
 - (b) tigers
 - (c) leopards
 - (d) lions
- 73.** The body parts of which animals have medicinal value in traditional Chinese medicine?
- (a) Tigers
 - (b) Leopards
 - (c) Lions
 - (d) All members of the cat family
- 74.** According to the passage, the dangerous groups that prey on are
- (a) sales-inspectors and Tserings
 - (b) smugglers and truckers
 - (c) illegal hunters and traditional apothecaries
 - (d) the police and the customs officials

PASSAGE 24

Pioneering Indian-American actor Sabu, who produced the 1940 classic *The Thief of Baghdad*, but could not make its sequel before his death in 1962, has had his dream come true 60 years later. All thanks to his daughter. Two years ago, Sabu's daughter Jasmine published *Moon Shadow : The Adventures of the Thief of Baghdad*, a tale for adolescent readers in which she resurrected Abu, The Thief of Baghdad, the character her father immortalised, who this time rescues the princess and the kingdom of Basrah from the machinations of Khaled, a neighbouring king.

- 75.** After producing the thief of Baghdad, Sabu wanted to
- (a) ensure the success of his daughter as an actress
 - (b) produce a play on the life of Khaled
 - (c) produce a sequel to *The Thief of Baghdad*
 - (d) retire from his job as a producer
- 76.** In his new incarnation, Abu emerges as
- (a) ruthless villain
 - (b) a benevolent hero
 - (c) an ardent lover
 - (d) an ideal king
- 77.** Sabu's dream has 'come true' means
- (a) his daughter has acted in a film
 - (b) his daughter has written a book
 - (c) Sabu has written a book
 - (d) his daughter has continued the story of Abu

PASSAGE 25

Why don't I have a telephone? Not because I pretend to be wise or pose an unusual. There are two chief reasons : because I don't really like the telephone and because I find I can still work and play, eat, breathe and sleep without it. Why don't I like the telephone? Because I think it is a pest and a time-waster. It may create unnecessary suspense and anxiety, as when you wait for an expected call that doesn't come or irritating delay as when you keep ringing a number that is always engaged. As for speaking in a public telephone booth, that seems to me really horrible. You would not use it unless you were in a hurry, you will find other people waiting before you.

- 78.** The author compares the telephone with a pest because it is
- (a) helpful to us
 - (b) harmful to us
 - (c) troublesome and destroys our spirit
 - (d) small and delicate
- 79.** According to the passage, waiting for an expected call that does not come, makes you feel
- (a) unnecessarily apprehensive
 - (b) the boredom of waiting
 - (c) important and proud
 - (d) nervous and worried
- 80.** Speaking in a public telephone booth is horrible because
- (a) you have to pay for it
 - (b) you have to talk in the presence of others
 - (c) you have to wait for your turn as you are in a hurry
 - (d) it is often out of order

PASSAGE 26

There are many types of protein molecules in the body and each type is specific to its function, e.g. proteins such as keratin and collagen give strength and elasticity to hair, as well as to skin and tendons; haemoglobin and myoglobin are the oxygen-binding proteins of the blood and the muscle, respectively and ovalbumin, the crucial protein of egg white is responsible for setting and foaming properties of eggs. A particularly important group of proteins known as enzymes, directs all the body cells chemical reactions. These reactions provide the basis of every type of cell activity, including growth, repair the production of energy and the excretion of waste productions.

- 81.** From the passage, it is clear that there are several types of proteins which
- can create problems in our body
 - carry out specific tasks
 - are found in all organisms
 - have interchangeable functions
- 82.** Proteins are classified according to
- the number of molecules
 - their names
 - their functions
 - the part of the body they are found in
- 83.** The function of the enzymes is to
- direct chemical reactions in body cells
 - bind oxygen in the blood
 - give strength and elasticity to hair
 - set and form properties of an egg

PASSAGE 27

My father and mother were the complements of each other. My mother was fragile, my father robust. Her face was responsive, my father's impassive. My mother's face ripples to emotions as waters to the wind. My mother was not intellectual. Her natural propensity was intuitive. Her face illustrated the saying : Appearances are deceptive, for did not show the immense strength of her moral convictions. No one could have inferred from it that she was capable of such fanaticism as she showed over them.

- 84.** By saying that his mother was the complement of his father the author suggests that she was
- like his father
 - opposed to his father
 - different from his father
 - indifferent to his father
- 85.** The words her face was responsive mean that
- her face clearly showed her feelings
 - her face was very attractive
 - her face was passive
 - one had to look at her face when she spoke
- 86.** The author's mother held strong views based on
- religious scriptures
 - legal provisions
 - social customs
 - ethical judgements

PASSAGE 28

While it is true that there is no law that compels us to say *please* or *kindly*, there is a social practice much older and much more sacred than any law which enjoins us to be civil. And the first requirement of civility is that we should acknowledge a service. *Please* or *Kindly* and *Thank you* are the small change with which we pay our way as social being. They are the little courtesies by which we keep the machine of life oiled and running sweetly. They put our intercourse upon the basis of a friendly cooperation and easy give and take instead of on the basis of superiors dictating inferiors. It is a very vulgar mind that would wish command where he can have the service for the asking, as have it with willingness and good feeling instead of resentment.

- 87.** According to the author,
- we should not say *Please* as it is against the law
 - we may or may not say *Please* according to our mood
 - to say *Please* is an outdated custom
 - we must say *Please* as it is a civilised custom
- 88.** The writer thinks that
- courtesies make life oily and sticky
 - the lesser the courtesies, the more the frankness in our life
 - courtesies make life pleasant
 - courtesies make life mechanical
- 89.** The writer is of the opinion that
- only subordinates should use *Please* and *Thank you* when talking to superiors
 - friends should use *Please* and *Thank you* only among themselves
 - Please* and *Thank you* should be used by everybody
 - Please* should be used by inferiors and *Thank you* by superiors

PASSAGE 29

It seems to me that we cannot learn too early in life to respect the privacy of the individual. When my daughter began to write her memoirs, at the age of four, I decided that she must have a place to keep them, if only a section of a bureau drawer or as it happened, a box with a key. I remembered the agonies of my own childhood when my sister discovered I was writing poems and began to tease me by chanting them in public. I tried desperately to hide the written notebook of poems. No place in the house seemed secure at all. For a while I carried it around in the right leg of my trousers until the elastic broke and the book fell out at the feet of enemy.

- 90.** The author arranged a safe place to keep the memoirs written by her daughter because he
- thought that the memoirs would be lost otherwise
 - recognised the need for respecting the privacy of her daughter
 - decided that the memoirs should not be read by strangers
 - knew that the memoirs could fetch a lot of money

- 91.** The author's sister caused great agony to him by
 (a) openly reciting the poems written by the author
 (b) discovering that the author was in the habit of writing poems
 (c) teasing her for the mistakes found in the poems
 (d) warning the author against writing any more poems
- 92.** No place in the house seemed secure enough to keep the notebook of poems; so the author
 (a) kept it in a bureau drawer
 (b) kept it in a box with a key
 (c) carried it inside the trousers
 (d) threw it at the feet of the enemy

PASSAGE 30

Humming birds are small, colourful birds with iridescent feathers. Their name comes from the fact that they flap their wings so fast (about 80 times per second) that they make a humming noise. Humming birds can fly right, left, up, down, backwards, and even upside down. They are also able to hover by flapping their wings in a figure-8 pattern. They have a specialized long and tapered bill that is used to obtain nectar from the center of long, tubular flowers. The humming bird's feet are used for perching only, and are not used for hopping or walking.

Humming birds primarily eat flower nectar, tree sap, insects and pollen. The humming bird's fast breathing rate, fast heartbeat and high body temperature require that they eat often. They also require an enormous amount of food each day. Humming birds have a long tongue which they use to lick their food at a rate of up to 13 licks per second.

- 93.** Humming birds get their name due to
 (a) their small size
 (b) their long beak
 (c) the humming noise made by them
 (d) their eating habits
- 94.** The word 'iridescent' in the passage means
 (a) dark (b) colourful (c) moist (d) glittering
- 95.** 'Bill' in the passage refers to the humming bird's
 (a) beak (b) feathers
 (c) eyes (d) feet
- 96.** Humming birds eat
 (a) nectar (b) tree sap
 (c) insects (d) All of these

PASSAGE 31

The practice of work done by under age child for making his/her family capable to survive in this world with basic needs is called "Child labour". This is now the biggest concern for whole world as children are the future of nation and if a child's future is healthy, safe and secure then automatically nation's future will be bright and successful.

Child labour is very harmful for young ones. It hinders their physical, moral and mental development. Though many reasons are there for child slavery or child trafficking but survey says that main cause of child labour are high level poverty and lack of access to good education. Development of the country is directly affected by this crime and child labour is a big reason of under-development of the country. A financially developed country provides all circumstances to its citizens that can help in making their new generations educated and healthy.

- 97.** Child labour is the biggest concern for
 (a) India (b) Asia
 (c) Europe (d) the whole world
- 98.** Child labour hinders a child's
 (a) mental development (b) physical development
 (c) moral development (d) All of these
- 99.** The main cause of child labour is
 (a) slavery (b) affluence
 (c) poverty (d) parent's punishment

PASSAGE 32

There are several things that put most normal people off birding, or bird-watching. Primary amongst them is the alleged requirement that you have to get up at 4 on a freezing winter morning, and traipse knee-deep in squelchy mud to the nearest swamp, peering through the fog with heavy binoculars around your neck. No, they won't penetrate it and you can safely go back to bed. Most sensible birds will remain tucked in their razais, heads buried in wings, fast asleep till at least noon in such conditions.

Another turn-off is this business with scientific names. Top-notch birders (sometimes trying to impress pretty fledgling birds in their group) will tell you that what you've seen is *Corvus splendens* and not a house crow. You can remain as happy describing it as a big black bird with a grey collar, beady eyes and a nasty beak, which behaves like the fellows who ragged you in school or first-year college.

- 100.** In the passage, bird-watching is also referred as
 (a) birdling (b) birding (c) birdathon (d) traipsing
- 101.** A word from the passage that means "walk or move wearily or reluctantly" is
 (a) squelch (b) fledgling (c) ragged (d) traipse
- 102.** *Corvus splendens* is also called as
 (a) bird (b) fledgling bird
 (c) house crow (d) rat
- 103.** Many people don't like bird-watching as
 (a) they hate birds
 (b) they have to get up at 4 am
 (c) they have to get up at 4 pm
 (d) they like animals more than birds
- 104.** The word 'beady eyes' means
 (a) sleepy eyes (b) watchful eyes
 (c) squinted eyes (d) tired eyes